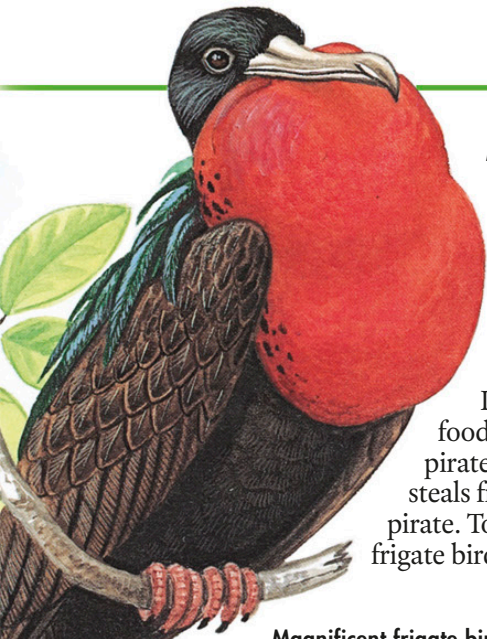




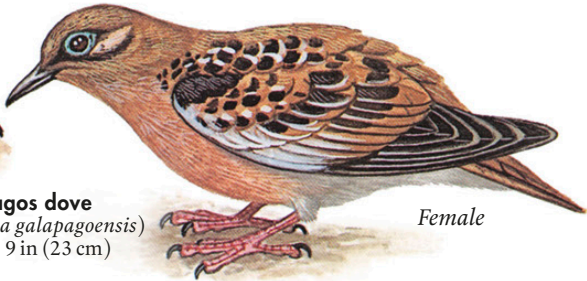
Magnificent frigate bird

The frigate bird soars over the islands on its huge wings. It feeds on turtles, jellyfish, and seabird chicks and can skim across the sea, lifting out fish with its hooked bill. It also chases other birds, such as boobies, to make them drop the food they are carrying. It then twists and turns to snatch the food in mid-air. It is named after the pirate ships called frigates because it steals from other birds rather like a pirate. To attract a mate, the male frigate bird puffs out his red throat.

Magnificent frigate bird
(*Fregata magnificens*)
Length: 3 ft 6 in (1 m 10 cm)
Wingspan: up to 8 ft (2 m 43 cm)



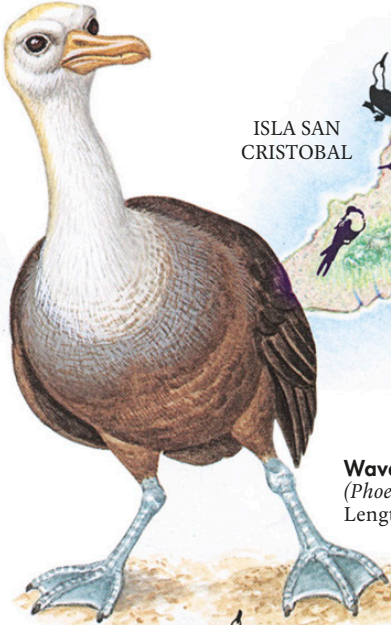
Male with
puffed up feathers



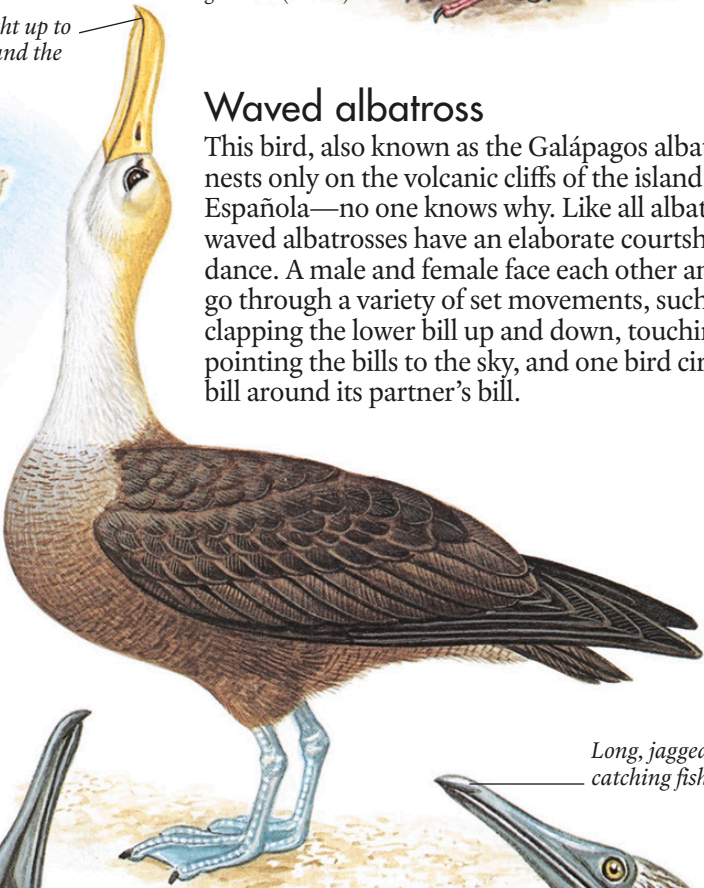
Galápagos dove
(*Zenaida galapagoensis*)
Length: 9 in (23 cm)

Female

Powerful bill points straight up to the sky during courtship and the bird “moos” like a cow.



Waved albatross
(*Phoebastria irrorata*)
Length: 3 ft (93 cm)



Long, jagged bill for catching fish underwater

Waved albatross

This bird, also known as the Galápagos albatross, nests only on the volcanic cliffs of the island of Española—no one knows why. Like all albatrosses, waved albatrosses have an elaborate courtship dance. A male and female face each other and go through a variety of set movements, such as clapping the lower bill up and down, touching sides, pointing the bills to the sky, and one bird circling its bill around its partner’s bill.

	FLIGHTLESS CORMORANT		WAVED ALBATROSS
	GALÁPAGOS PENGUIN		GALÁPAGOS DOVE
	BLUE-FOOTED BOOBY		MAGNIFICENT FRIGATE BIRD
	GRAY WARBLER-FINCH		WOODPECKER FINCH
	SMALL TREE-FINCH		LARGE GROUND-FINCH



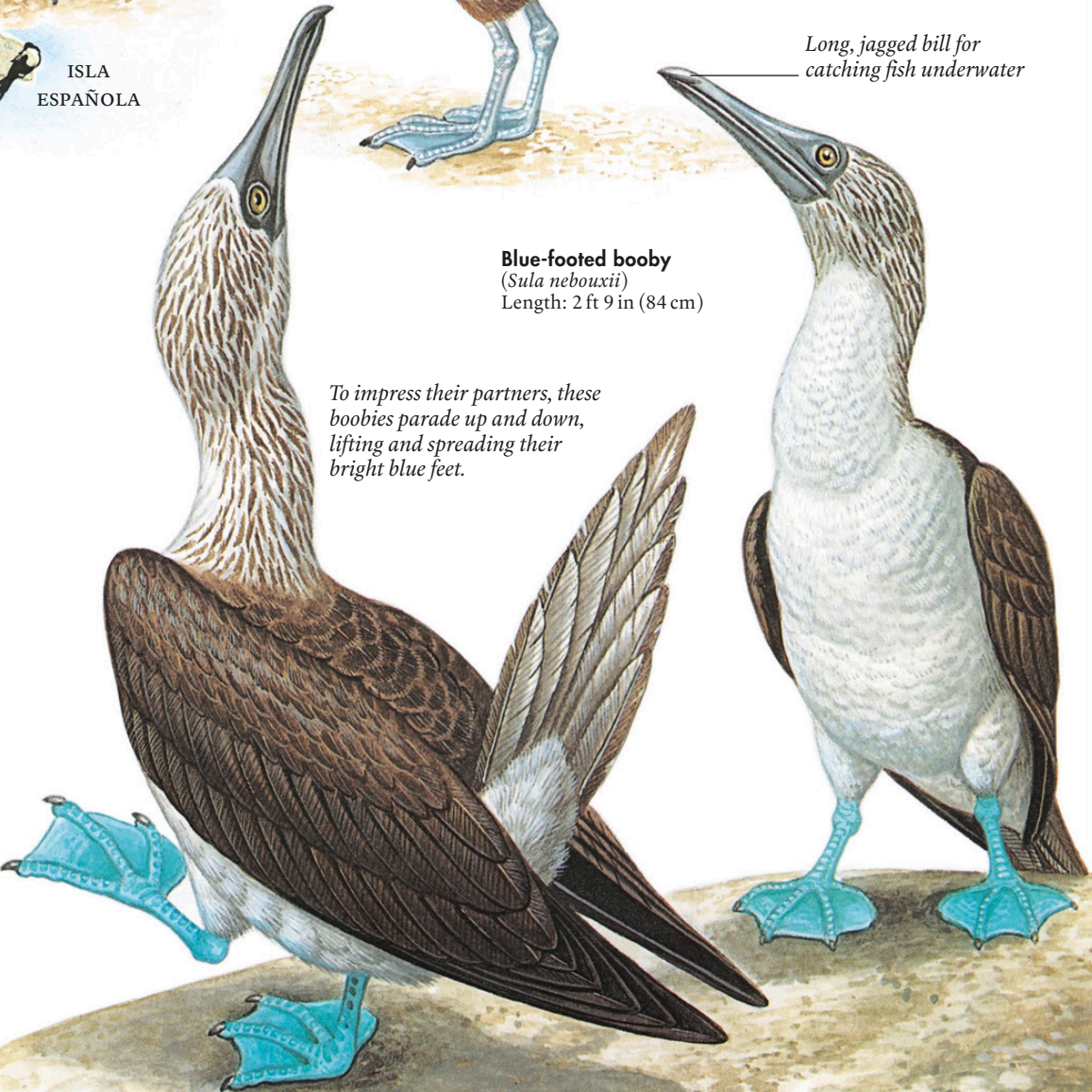
ISLA SANTA MARIA



The Galápagos Islands were formed by volcanoes erupting in the Pacific Ocean. Much of the landscape consists of jagged, black volcanic rock.

Blue-footed booby

These birds nest in small, scattered colonies. Unlike other boobies, they feed close to the shore. This means that the different species of booby do not compete with each other. Because they have a good food supply nearby, blue-footed boobies can raise two or three young a year, whereas other species of booby only raise one chick at a time. The young boobies are fed on fish coughed up by their parents. The booby’s strange name comes from the Spanish word *bobo*, which means “clown.”



To impress their partners, these boobies parade up and down, lifting and spreading their bright blue feet.

Blue-footed booby
(*Sula nebouxii*)
Length: 2 ft 9 in (84 cm)